

ONE BULLET

Prompt & Play — Game Concept / Page 1 of 2

There is exactly one bullet in the entire arena, and every character shares it. It never respawns, because it was never really anyone's to begin with — it is a single, physical, contested object, and whoever holds it is the only one who can kill. Everyone else, including the player most of the time, is unarmed. Even the title screen doesn't sit idle: two AI bots are already fighting over it behind the menu, so the concept reads in the first second, before a single key is pressed.

How it plays

Move with WASD, aim with the mouse, and when the round is lying loose on the floor, sprint for it before a hostile does. Firing is a single click — but the instant you pull the trigger, you give up the only thing keeping you alive. The bullet becomes a fast, dodgeable object again, landing wherever it lands, and now everyone left standing, possibly including the enemy you just missed, is racing to claim it. Five escalating waves test whether you can hold your nerve: take the shot, or wait for a cleaner one. Hostiles aim faster and more accurately every wave, and a round left untouched too long starts to pulse and relocates itself, so no one can camp and wait the clock out. On phones and tablets, twin virtual joysticks take over automatically — drag the left half to move, the right half to aim in any direction and fire. The first time anyone opens it, three on-screen callouts teach the entire loop by pointing at it as it happens, then never appear again.

What makes it original

Shooters almost always assume abundant, personal ammunition; tension comes from aim, cover, or managing a resource across many bullets. One Bullet removes that assumption entirely — lethality itself becomes a single, scarce, physical object shared by the whole arena, a MacGuffin repurposed as a weapon. That one change produces behaviour the genre rarely sees: baiting an opponent away from the round, breaking line of sight the instant after firing, or deliberately not taking a clean shot because reclaiming position matters more than the kill. It is a game about possession and nerve, not reflexes or ammo counts.

Feel and craft

Every hit is fatal for player and enemy alike, so each encounter is a held breath, not a drawn-out fight. Enemies telegraph an incoming shot with a laser sightline, a red vignette rises as danger builds, and screen shake, particle bursts, brief slow-motion on the killing blow, and live-synthesized Web Audio sound effects give one tiny object real physical weight. Best wave and elimination count persist between runs. The entire game is one self-contained, fully responsive HTML/Canvas file, built and iteratively play-tested across desktop, tablet and phone with Claude Code as build partner — through repeated rounds of deliberate bug-hunting that found and fixed real defects (a wave-clear condition that could re-trigger itself, a kill wrongly credited from AI friendly fire, a tutorial callout that kept pointing at the round after an enemy had already claimed it) before this version shipped.

There is only one bullet in the world. Everything else is just people trying to get to it first.

Prompts Used

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- 1 Shared the official Prompt & Play contest guidelines (theme, judging criteria, and submission format) as the brief to work from.
- 2 "THE THEME IS HERE! Challenge: Build a Game — Any Concept, Any Type. Design and build a game — any concept, any genre, any style you can imagine. The only requirement: it has to be innovative. Use AI prompting to bring your idea to life from concept to final build." (full brief pasted, including judging criteria and the two-page PDF submission format).
- 3 "Research everything and build me for this. As it has AI tools usage so i can use claude code as my teammate. Build me best project of this."
- 4 Asked to choose a build path — selected "Pitch me ideas" from: pitch ideas / I already have a concept / surprise me.
- 5 Reviewed four original concept pitches (One Bullet, Echo Run, The Unreliable Map, Reverse Boss) and chose to proceed with the strongest single-sentence hook.
- 6 "Research everything and then go with it. Should be in top teams so need bestest one."
- 7 "I should be in Top 10 teams of this contest. so take time and plan the best."
- 8 "Research everything and then go with it. Should be in top teams so need bestest one." (confirmed direction; proceed to build, test in a live browser, and fix any bugs found before shipping).
- 9 "First project should be worth to judges. So look everything i given details right of the contest." — prompted re-reading the official guidelines PDF directly to confirm exact submission format (two pages, team header, live link) before finalizing.
- 10 Provided team details (team name and members) to complete the Page 1 header of this submission document.
- 11 "What additional we can make now in current game to make it more strong and top one?" — extended the build with a per-wave difficulty curve and flavour text, an untouched-round urgency timer that self-relocates the bullet, brief slow-motion on the killing blow, and persistent best-run tracking.
- 12 "See the flaws and fix them too." — full code review pass; found and fixed a kill wrongly credited from AI friendly fire, a danger-telegraph that no longer matched the new per-wave difficulty, a slow-motion effect leaking into the next wave, and a stuck-movement edge case on losing window focus.
- 13 "Make it more perfect. Add features if needed. Need to be in top teams of contest. Fully research, plan, implement and provide me best." — added a live attract-mode demo (AI bots fight over the round behind the title screen, so the concept reads before a single key is pressed) and a persistent mute toggle for quiet judging environments.
- 14 "Make sure it works in all devices. Responsive to all devices freely." / "Yes, make sure it is suitable for all devices browser's." — found that touch input only handled aiming, with no way to move on a phone or tablet; replaced it with twin virtual joysticks (drag left to move, drag right to aim in any direction and fire), fixed the aim math so it isn't limited to one screen half, added adaptive on-screen instructions, and verified the full flow on desktop, tablet and mobile viewports.
- 15 "I still don't understand what's the game is. But all i ask is want to be in top 10 teams... choose another game or make current one perfect... i need best and outstanding result with no flaws." — decided to keep the concept (it is sound and explains in one paragraph) rather than restart, and fixed the real problem: the game never taught itself. Added a first-time-only guided sequence that teaches the whole loop through on-screen callouts tied to what is actually happening (find the round, you're armed, you're unarmed, go again), verified step by step, then never shown again once learned.
- 16 "Check the live game now and verify everything." — deployed to production (one-bullet.vercel.app) and GitHub, then re-verified the live build itself rather than trusting the local test: found and fixed one more real bug live on production (the tutorial pointing at the round after an enemy already claimed it), redeployed, and confirmed the fix on the live URL before finalizing this document.